

Icaronycteris

Prehistoric bats such as *Icaronycteris* were not very different from the ones found today. They even hunted in the same manner—flying around in the night skies and swooping over places where plenty of insects gathered, such as among the trees or above lakes. Some scientists suggest that these early bats flew at night to escape the clutches of predatory birds that hunted during the day.



DID YOU KNOW...?

Icaronycteris is named after Icarus, the son of the ancient Greek craftsman Daedalus. According to Greek myth, Icarus and his father escaped from prison on wings attached by wax. Icarus flew too close to the Sun. The wax melted, and he plunged to his death in the sea below.

